



**DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
UNITED STATES SPACE FORCE
HEADQUARTERS SPACE OPERATIONS COMMAND**

DETERMINATION AND FINDINGS - CONSOLIDATION OF CONTRACT REQUIREMENTS

Program Title: Communications, Network, Engineering, Cybersecurity, and Information Technology Services (CNECTS, aka "Connects")

Contracting Activity: Space Acquisition Integration Office (SAIO)
135 Dover Street, STE 2041
Peterson SFB, 80914

Requesting Activity: 21st Communications Squadron (21 CS)
[REDACTED]

Category and Estimated Value: Services / [REDACTED] after consolidation)

This Determination and Findings (D&F) is prepared in accordance with (IAW) Federal Acquisition regulation (FAR) 1.7 to support the determination to consolidate requirements previously performed under two or more separate contracts and issue a single award that will satisfy these requirements of the United States Department of the Air Force. FAR 2.101 defines consolidation as a solicitation for a single contract, a multiple-award contract, a task order, or a delivery order to satisfy two or more requirements of the Federal agency for supplies or services that have been provided to or performed for the Federal agency under two or more separate contracts, each of which was lower in cost than the total cost of the contract for which offers are solicited. The justification and rationale contained within this determination and findings comply with the requirements set forth in FAR 7.107-2, Consolidation.

FINDINGS

- 1) Description of Procurement Action.** The Space Acquisition and Integration Office (SAIO) plans to solicit offers for the Communications, Network, Engineering, Cybersecurity, and Information Technology Services (CNECTS, aka "Connects") contract, covering 21st Communications Squadron (21 CS) requirements across Peterson SFB (PSFB), Schriever SFB (SSFB), and Cheyenne Mountain Space Force Station (CMSFS). The Contractor will be required to furnish all management, supervision, labor, materials, equipment, and incidentals required for operations and maintenance of information systems infrastructure and related support services across these installations [not including any Government-Furnished Property (GFP) that may be provided]. Specific services to be accomplished include hardware and software maintenance, software and license management, network and system administration support, help desk, communications focal point, cybersecurity monitoring, and disaster recovery planning. Each current requirement proposed for consolidation is further described in paragraph 2. These information systems directly support the following organizations: The United States Space Force (USSF) [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

SEMPER VENATOR



The applicable North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code for this procurement is 517810 – All Other Telecommunications, with a size standard of \$40M:

This industry comprises establishments primarily engaged in providing specialized telecommunications services, such as satellite tracking, communications telemetry, and radar station operation. This industry also includes establishments primarily engaged in providing satellite terminal stations and associated facilities connected with one or more terrestrial systems and capable of transmitting telecommunications to, and receiving telecommunications from, satellite systems. Establishments providing Internet services or Voice over Internet protocol (VoIP) services via client-supplied telecommunications connections are also included in this industry. Establishments in this industry do not operate as telecommunications carriers.

This NAICS code was selected as the most appropriate because the individual contracts making up this consolidated requirement all have different NAICS codes (described below). Therefore, the “all other” NAICS code was the best fit to encompass all types of work projected under this contract. In addition, market research was conducted, specifically asking industry their thoughts on the most appropriate NAICS code. Most responses (14 out of 24) concurred with 517810, and it has been determined to be the most appropriate for this acquisition. The full discussion of how the acquisition team determined this NAICS code to be appropriate, including considering industry feedback on alternatives, will be contained in the Market Research Report, once it is completed.

- 2) **Scope of Existing Requirements.** The requirements proposed for this consolidation effort are currently being accomplished under four (4) separate contracts:

SEMPER VENATOR

- **[REDACTED] Base Operating Support-Information Technology (BOS-IT).**
 - The scope of this contract encompasses all services required to support the operation, maintenance, and logistics of the PSFB and SSFB Installation Base Operating Support Information Technology (BOS-IT) systems. This effort includes the ability to provide support to various PSFB, SSFB, and off-installation information and communications systems and associated tenant organizations. During the performance of this contract, the contractor shall provide non-personal services in support of operations, maintenance, logistics management, testing and all other requirements within the BOS-IT Performance Work Statement (PWS). Support includes potential future requirements, emerging technologies, system growth, and new/upgraded equipment as needed.
 - This contract has a period of performance of [REDACTED] with an option to extend it up to six additional months. [REDACTED]
 - [REDACTED] contractor under NAICS code [REDACTED], with a small business-size standard of \$34M.

- **[REDACTED], Cheyenne Mountain SFS 21 CS Communications Contract.**
 - This contract is not yet awarded and consists of the 21 CS-related requirements at CMSFS. This work is currently being done under the North American Aerospace Defense Command Cheyenne Mountain Complex – Integrated Tactical Warning/Attack Assessment (NCMC-ITW/AA) and Space Support Contract (NISSC), administered by Space Systems Command (SSC). NISSC is going to be split into two contracts: the mission-related IT/WAA requirements will continue under “NISSC III,” and the base-related and mission support communications requirements will be split out and accomplished under this contract, which will be awarded as bridge contract to the current NISSC incumbent. This contract is expected to be awarded in [REDACTED]
 - This contract supports requirements for operations and maintenance of the CMSFS Information Systems Infrastructure, including the administration and specialized security, communications, computing, and network systems that make up the CMSFS base information systems. The systems consist of commercial-off-the-shelf (COTS), Government-Off- The-Shelf (GOTS), Free and Open-Source Software (FOSS), and specialized hardware and software. Major components to 21 CS covered systems are application servers, database servers, workstations, communication equipment, switches and virtual machines.
 - This contract has a period of performance of [REDACTED] ending on [REDACTED] with [REDACTED] options. It is valued at approximately [REDACTED] in total, including the two six-month extensions.
 - This contract is currently being performed by [REDACTED] a large business

contractor under NAICS code [REDACTED]
[REDACTED], with a small business size standard of \$34M.

- [REDACTED], **Wing Information & Communications Support (WICS)**

- The scope of this contract encompasses all services required to support the operation, maintenance, and logistics of the SSFB Installation information and communications systems covered under the WICS contract. This effort includes the ability to provide support to various SSFB Installation information and communications systems and associated tenant organizations. During the performance of this contract, the contractor shall provide non-personal services in support of operations, mission systems maintenance and maintenance management, logistics management, communication support, security and emergency notification systems, testing and all other requirements within the WICS II Performance Work Statement (PWS). Support also includes potential future requirements, emerging technologies, system growth, and new/upgraded equipment as needed.
- This contract has a period of performance of [REDACTED] ending on [REDACTED], with an option to extend it up to [REDACTED] months. It is valued at approximately [REDACTED], including the six-month extension.
- This contract is currently being performed by [REDACTED], an 8(a) small business contractor under NAICS code [REDACTED], with a small business size standard of \$44M.

- [REDACTED] **Plans and Programs Engineering Design Support (PEDS)**

- The scope of this contract is to provide systems engineering, design, installation, testing (transport only), and documentation of secure/non-secure telephone, video, data, transport, and computer network systems for SSFB organizations, tenant units, and any off-site organization which requires connection to the Defense Information Systems Agency (DISA) and Base Operational Support (BOS) point-of-presence (POP).
- This contract has a period of performance of [REDACTED] ending on [REDACTED] with an option to extend it up to [REDACTED] months. It is valued at approximately [REDACTED] in total, including the six-month extension.
- This contract is currently being performed by [REDACTED], an 8(a) small business contractor under NAICS code [REDACTED], with a small business size standard of \$34M.

3) Period of Performance. The proposed CNECTS Period of Performance is projected as follows:

[REDACTED] [REDACTED]



As described above, the current contracts all have different end dates. The first contract to end will be BOS-IT, which expires on 31 July 2027, and is what drives the CNECTS start date of 1 August 2027. The remaining contracts will be onboarded to the CNECTS contract as they expire. The Cheyenne Mountain requirement will be the first to be on board on 30 November 2027, followed by the WICS requirement on 30 March 2028. Finally, the PEDS requirement will be onboarded on 28 June 2028.

4) **Basis for Consolidation.**

21 CS is currently the requirement owner for all four current contracts (WICS has additional requirement owners, and only the 21 CS requirements will be added to CNECTS; the remaining requirements will continue under the WICS follow-on acquisition, separate from this effort). As the Space Force has stood up, organized, and reorganized, these separate contracts have come to fall under separate organizations, each with its own commander, priorities, funding, and location. For example, each contract is currently managed by separate organizations, and 21 CS Contracting Officer Representatives (CORs) are designated by, and report to, separate Contracting Officers:

- BOS-IT is currently managed by the 21st Contracting Squadron (21 CONS) under Space Base Delta 1 (SBD-1)
- The Cheyenne Mountain contract is managed by Space Systems Command (SSC)
- WICS is currently managed by SAIO under SpOC
- PEDS is currently managed by the 50th Contracting Squadron (50 CONS) under Space Base Delta 41 (SBD-41)

This construct has systemic inefficiencies, all of which this consolidation effort seeks to remedy or mitigate:

- Significant duplication of costs (explained in detail below in paragraph 6.a.).
- Inefficient use of 21 CS personnel (explained in detail below in paragraph 6.b.i.).
- Inconsistency between civilian and contractor work (explained in detail below in paragraph 6.a.iv.).

- 5) **Market Research.** A Request for Information (RFI) was posted on 31 July 2025 for 20 days on SAM.gov. The purpose of the RFI was to inform industry that the Government was beginning this consolidation analysis. Also, the RFI sought information to assess the small business impact of the potential consolidation and determine if maintaining a 100% small business set-aside was feasible. The RFI provided the PWSs of the four requirements contemplated for potential consolidation, as well as 17 questions designed to assess the specific impact on small business, along with other benefits, drawbacks, and alternatives.

The RFI received 24 responses in total. 16 of the 24 respondent companies are considered a

small business based on NAICS code 517810. The other eight respondents were large businesses. All 24 respondents indicated interest in proposing as a prime contractor. After reviewing the RFI responses from all 24 companies, it was determined by 21 CS and SAIO evaluators that 13 of the 16 small business respondent companies are capable of performing the CNECTS requirements. The requirements as outlined within all four PWSs as well as the specific RFI questions led to the determination that small business is still capable to perform the consolidated CNECTS requirements.

Market research is the primary tool for assessing small business capabilities and determining the appropriate acquisition strategy. Sixteen small businesses that responded to the Request for Information (RFI) were proficient in the most relevant capabilities for this acquisition. Of these, five specialize in cloud migration, six specialize in data analytics, and five offer a broader range of IT support. Of the 16 small businesses, 10 of them are 8(a) companies, and all 10 are considered capable of performing the consolidated CNECTS requirements. All 10 also indicated they would propose as a prime contractor.

a) Alternative Contracting Approaches. There are four alternatives that have been identified and considered:

- i) **Status quo.** Keeping the existing organization and structure would preserve all the inefficiencies this consolidation effort is meant to mitigate. This option is the least preferable because it fails to realize substantial monetary benefits [REDACTED] as well as significant improvements in efficiency and management of the services for USSF. Maintaining the status quo would preserve opportunities for the existing small business contractors, but would sacrifice significant cost savings and efficiency improvements, as detailed in Section 6.
- ii) **Separate contracts under one contracting organization.** One of the inefficiencies of the current structure is the inefficient use of Contracting and 21 CS personnel, including that 21 CS CORs report to four different COs in four different contracting organizations. Keeping the contracts separate but moving them under one executing contracting unit could potentially mitigate the Contracting side of this problem by creating some administration efficiencies, for example by requiring only two or three COs instead of four (see paragraph 6.a.iii). But it would do nothing to save direct and indirect contract costs, which make up most of the monetary savings (see paragraphs 6.a.i and ii, and Table 4). Additionally, many of the existing inefficiencies with 21 CS personnel would remain. For example, CORs would still have to submit multiple Contract Status Reports (CSRs) instead of one, duplication of surveillance efforts, etc.). See paragraph 6.b.i below for additional details on the inefficient use of 21 CS CORs.
- iii) **Lesser degree of consolidation.** Certain contracts could be consolidated, and others kept separate. For example, one industry response to the RFI suggested consolidating BOS-IT and Cheyenne Mountain, but keeping PEDS and WICS separate, although they did not provide a specific rationale for that combination. A lesser degree of consolidation would possibly mitigate some inefficiencies, but it would not solve them, and it would not yield substantial cost savings. For example, Table 2 below shows that consolidation brings anticipated cost savings *and* some cost increases. Virtually the entire cost increase comes

from combining BOS-IT and Cheyenne Mountain, because certain work centers would have to be separated, and additional FTEs would need to be hired. This split is necessary because those functions are currently being performed on the legacy North American Aerospace Defense Command Cheyenne Mountain Complex – Integrated Tactical Warning/Attack Assessment (NCMC-ITW/AA) and Space Support Contract (NISSC) contract under one work center, and that work will need to continue on NISSC II under that follow-on. So, that same work that needs to be done under the consolidated effort will need to be added, resulting in a total of two work centers instead of one. Therefore, if only BOS-IT and Cheyenne Mountain are consolidated, it would reduce the overall cost savings from [REDACTED]. Also backing out the profit and overhead savings, partial consolidation would not exceed the “measurably substantial” threshold of [REDACTED] (see paragraph 6).

In addition, 22 of the 24 respondents to the RFI believed full consolidation was feasible, and 23 of 24 believed meaningful efficiencies would be gained through consolidation. When asked for alternatives, industry stated either there were no better alternatives (seven responses) or provided some but caveated that any alternative would eliminate or reduce the clear cost savings and efficiency gains and would ultimately not be recommended (12 responses). For example, the following excerpts represent the 12 responses identifying – but ultimately not recommending – alternatives:

“An alternative approach would be the separation of contracts by base. Management and quality control of a localized team would be easier for local government contracting officials. However, it seems that this would reduce the efficiencies gained by consolidating into a single contract award and associated CDRLs, so we don’t see it as a better answer.”

“While full consolidation of these requirements into a single, multi-functional, multi-CLIN contract remains the preferred approach for maximizing efficiency, standardization, and accountability, we recognize that the Government may wish to consider alternative structures to balance operational risk. Options such as partial consolidation by functional category, geographic-based grouping of requirements, a Prime/subcontractor alliance model, or phased integration offer viable pathways to achieve many of the same benefits with a reduced degree of change.”

“While [REDACTED] supports full consolidation of the requirements into a single contract, we recognize three potential alternative approaches the Government may consider: Functional Consolidation: Grouping tasks by mission area... Regional Consolidation: Aligning contracts by base or installation... Customer Consolidation (Funding Lines): Structuring awards around funding streams or mission owners... That said, based on our review, AFCM believes the current level of consolidation is optimal, as it maximizes efficiency, standardization, and resource flexibility across all sites and mission areas.”

“While [REDACTED] primary recommendation is for full consolidation under a large prime, an alternative approach that could be considered to maintain small business opportunities would require a lesser degree of consolidation. This could entail consolidating BOS-IT and Giant Voice under one contract, while keeping

Cheyenne Mountain SFS 21 CS Communications and PEDS separate.”

Of the firms that did recommend alternatives, the alternatives included either a lesser degree of consolidation, or a multiple-award IDIQ. For the reasons described in this paragraph and paragraph 5.a.iv below, neither alternative is considered feasible.

Based on the RFI responses, all options for a lesser degree of consolidation do not appear to have any substantive impact (positive or negative) on small business participation in this effort. The only apparent impact is the magnitude of the savings to the government in terms of monetary benefits and efficiencies gained. Thus, the only *de facto* viable options are either full consolidation or no consolidation.

iv) Multiple-award IDIQ. A multiple-award IDIQ would allow the Government to award multiple contracts to meet the overall CNECTS requirement. However, multiple awards under an IDIQ are only appropriate when the requirement meets the conditions in FAR 16.504(c)(1)(ii), including ensuring that the projected task orders are not so integrally related that only a single contractor can reasonably perform the work. Rather, a single award providing additional benefits not available under multiple awards as noted in FAR 16.504(c)(ii)B(B), (B) The contracting officer must not use the multiple award approach if-

- (1) Only one contractor is capable of providing performance at the level of quality required because the supplies or services are unique or highly specialized;
- (2) Based on the contracting officer’s knowledge of the market, more favorable terms and conditions, including pricing, will be provided if a single award is made;
- (3) The expected cost of administration of multiple contracts outweighs the expected benefits of making multiple awards;
- (4) The projected task orders are so integrally related that only a single contractor can reasonably perform the work;
- (5) The total estimated value of the contract is at or below the simplified acquisition threshold; or
- (6) Multiple awards would not be in the best interests of the Government.

(C) The contracting officer must document the decision whether or not to use multiple awards in the acquisition plan or contract file. The contracting officer may determine that a class of acquisitions is not appropriate for multiple awards (see subpart 1.7).

For this consolidated requirement, it realistically only makes sense for a single contractor to perform the work. The scope of the requirements overlap and are integrated with each other, both across requirements and across locations. For example, the Communications Focal Point (CFP) requirement spans across all installations and touches virtually every other requirement area. The CFP is the central hub to which all help tickets come in, and from there, depending on the nature of the problem, are either delegated to the other work centers, or handled immediately by the CFP tech.

Therefore, it would be impractical to split this requirement either by location or function. If a different contractor did this at each location, it would neutralize the consolidation savings and benefits. If one contractor executed this function, but other contractors did other functions the CFP relies on, artificial seams would be created, and accountability

for solving the problem would not belong to a single contractor, increasing the risk that required tasks fall through the cracks, or are not accomplished with unified urgency. Furthermore, functions such as cybersecurity incident response and network defense require a unified command and control structure. Dividing these responsibilities among multiple contractors would create unacceptable delays and seams in security, jeopardizing the critical NORAD/USNORTHCOM missions. Similar considerations exist for the other work centers. Finally, a multiple-award IDIQ would negate the benefits to be gained related to the offboarding of certain requirements related to the BIM and GSA consolidation efforts (more details below in paragraph 6.b.ii.).

Small Business Effect. This consolidation will result in a reduction in the number of prime contract opportunities for small businesses, representing a potential adverse impact that requires careful consideration and justification under FAR Part 19. The proposed consolidation will result in a reduction in the number of prime small business firms being utilized from three to one (the Cheyenne Mountain requirement is currently being performed by a large business), but market research indicates that a small business set-aside is appropriate. As noted above, 16 of the companies capable of performing the work are small businesses and explicitly expressed interest as a prime. This indicates that offers will be received from at least two responsible small business concerns. In addition, there is adequate interest from capable 8(a) businesses to conduct this acquisition as a competitive 8(a) set-aside, meaning the work currently done under the PEDS and WICS II contracts can remain in the 8(a) program. Additionally, while consolidation reduces the total number of contracts available for small business, it redirects a significant amount [REDACTED] to small businesses that are currently performed by large business under the NISSC contract. It will also redirect a significant amount [REDACTED] into the 8(a) program by bringing into it the current BOS-IT and CMFSFS requirements. Given the intent of this acquisition to remain with small business, an 8(a) competitive acquisition strategy provides for maximum practicable participation by small businesses within the 8(a) program, and therefore there is no negative impact on small business IAW FAR 7.107-2(a). Market research was performed to maximize small business opportunities in this consolidated acquisition while maintaining agency efficiency and mission effectiveness. In accordance with FAR Part 19, the relevant agencies promoted small business participation, as described in paragraph 5a. SAIO's strong commitment to small disadvantaged businesses and their contribution to the Defense Industrial Base is evident in exceeding its SDB goal, detailed in Table 1

Table 1 – SAIO Small Business Goals

SAIO	Goal	Actual	Delta
SB	44.00%	50.70%	6.70%
SDB (Includes 8(a))	24.00%	33.8%	9.80%
SDVOSB	10.00%	11.60%	1.60%
WOSB	2.00%	3.60%	1.60%
HUBZONE	2.00%	5.00%	3.00%

- 6) **Benefit(s).** The benefits gained from consolidation are expected to be substantial. FAR 7.107-3(d) states that benefits that are quantifiable in dollar amounts are considered “measurably substantial,” and thus justifiable, if individually, in combination, or in the aggregate the anticipated financial benefits are equivalent to five percent of the estimated contract or order value (including options) or \$9.4 million, whichever is greater, if the value exceeds \$94 million.

The combined value of the four separate requirements is approximately [REDACTED], or approximately [REDACTED], assuming a [REDACTED] period of performance. Therefore, the consolidation must demonstrate at least [REDACTED] in total savings [REDACTED], or approximately [REDACTED] per year. In addition to monetary benefits, other non-monetary or non-quantifiable benefits were also considered.

a) **Monetary benefits.** The total monetary benefits expected to be gained through consolidation equal at least [REDACTED] per year, or [REDACTED] over the life of the contract. These savings will be realized through reductions or elimination of direct contract costs, indirect contract costs, contract access fees (CAF), and administrative savings. Each is described below.

i) **Direct Contract Costs.** A note about the monetary benefits associated with direct contract costs: those listed below are the areas where cost savings are expected to be realized. Consolidation will not result in cost savings in all areas of the overall requirement and will even result in increased costs in certain areas. A summary of the areas where cost savings are positive, neutral, and negative, along with the overall net result, is provided in Table 2 below. That said, the net direct contract cost monetary benefits expected to be gained through consolidation exceed [REDACTED] per year, or over [REDACTED] over the life of the contract. These monetary benefits are realized through eliminating duplication and triplication of effort and thus reducing Full Time Equivalent (FTE) contractor employees across the requirements. There are other potential savings that could be realized in the future in certain work centers that are not included in this analysis because those savings are not reasonably certain. The work centers with reasonably certain savings are described below and summarized in Table 2. These cost savings were calculated by taking the current contract rates and hours for each position:

- (1) **Local Registration Authority (LRA).** Currently, there are a total of [REDACTED] FTEs performing LRA type duties. [REDACTED] performs LRA-specific supervisory duties for PSFB and SSFB. There are [REDACTED] each at PSFB, SSFB, and CMSFS performing LRA duties. The combined annual cost for all [REDACTED] LRA FTEs is currently [REDACTED]. Through consolidation under one contractor, and by realigning work centers (see paragraph 6.a.iv below), the Client Systems Teams (CSTs) at PSFS can absorb the LRA duties, for all locations eliminating this cost, saving [REDACTED] per year. There are currently [REDACTED] CSTs across SSFB, PSFB, and CMSFS and none of these positions would be eliminated during the consolidation and would be able to absorb the LRA workload.
- (2) **Communications Focal Point (CFP).** There are currently [REDACTED] FTEs performing CFP functions: [REDACTED] each at SSFB and PSFB, and [REDACTED] at CMSFS, and each location has their own CFP office and individual work center supervisors. All CFP functions are performed via desktop applications/voice services and can be consolidated both physically and virtually. Through consolidation, these three offices can be combined into one which can service all three locations. This would allow the total FTE number to be reduced to [REDACTED], saving a total of [REDACTED] per year.
- (3) **Network Operations Center (NOC).** There are currently [REDACTED] FTEs working in the NOC at CMSFS. Through consolidation, the CFP will be able to perform a significant portion of the NOC duties, reducing the FTE count from [REDACTED] resulting in a cost savings of [REDACTED] per year.

- (4) **Giant Voice.** There are currently [REDACTED] FTEs performing Giant Voice preventive maintenance and repair/replacement functions for SSFB [REDACTED] PSFB [REDACTED] and CMSFS [REDACTED], across two contracts. CMSFS Giant Voice requirements were initially resource-intensive due to the deployment of a new system. With operational maturity achieved, ongoing support demands have substantially decreased. PSFB and SSFB are larger sites and require a full quarter to complete all Preventive Maintenance Inspections (PMIs). CMSFS, however, is more compact, allowing the PMIs to be completed in just a few days, and thus absorbed into another labor category. Consolidation would allow this requirement to be carried out by [REDACTED] across all locations, saving [REDACTED] per year.
- (5) **Training.** There are currently [REDACTED] FTEs across three contracts responsible for training, [REDACTED] at PSFB and SSFB under BOS-IT, [REDACTED] at Schriever under WICS, and [REDACTED] at CMSFS. Consolidation would allow the requirement to be performed by [REDACTED] FTEs to provide training to all locations, saving [REDACTED] per year.
- (6) **General Manager.** There are currently four General Managers, one for each contract, at an average annual cost of [REDACTED] each. Consolidation would allow the entire requirement to be overseen by only one General Manager, saving [REDACTED] per year.
- (7) **General Manager Deputy.** The BOS-IT and CMSFS contracts each have one Deputy General Manager, at an average annual cost of [REDACTED] each. Consolidation would allow at least one of these positions to be eliminated, saving at least [REDACTED] per year.
- (8) **Site Director.** There are currently four Site Directors, one at each site under each contract, at an average annual cost of [REDACTED] each. Consolidation would allow the two Site Directors at SSFB to be reduced to one, saving approximately [REDACTED] per year.
- (9) **Program Management Office (PMO).** Specific PMO costs are only identified in the Cheyenne Mountain requirement, in the amount of [REDACTED] per year. However, logic dictates that consolidating the requirements would reduce the total PMO cost by approximately 25%, or by about [REDACTED] per year.
- (10) **Land Mobile Radio (LMR).** There is currently one FTE performing LMR requirements at CMSFS. This function is currently being performed by civilians at the other sites. Consolidation would allow this function to be absorbed by the civilian workforce, saving [REDACTED] per year. Work center realignment is described further in paragraph 6.a.iv below.

Table 2 –Direct Cost Impact by Work Center (Annually)

Work Center	Current FTEs	Annual FTE Cost	Combined annual work center cost	Number of FTE Reduction	Consolidated FTE Count	Consolidation Savings
Work Centers with Expected Cost Savings						
LRA		0				
CFP						
NOC						
Giant Voice						
Training						
GM						
GM Deputy						
Site Director						
PMO						
LMR						
Work Centers with Expected Cost Increases						
TCF						
Cable						
DRSN						
Total Net Annual Savings						

ii) **Indirect Contract Costs.** Indirect cost savings expected to be gained through consolidation exceed [REDACTED] per year, or over [REDACTED] over the life of the contract. These savings will be realized by eliminating or reducing the amount of profit and overhead the Government pays, Contract Access Fees, and administrative costs of conducting acquisitions. Each is described below.

(1) **Profit and overhead.** This consolidation ensures the Government will not pay quadruplicate indirect costs or profit. Specific contract cost savings expected are [REDACTED] per year, details as follows:

- (a) Under the BOS-IT contract the Government is currently paying annual costs of [REDACTED] in overhead (OH), [REDACTED] for General and Administrative (G&A), and [REDACTED] for profit, for a total of [REDACTED] per year.
- (b) Under the Cheyenne Mountain contract, the Government estimates it will pay annual costs of [REDACTED] for OH, [REDACTED] for G&A, and [REDACTED] for profit, for a total of [REDACTED] per year.
- (c) Under the PEDS contract the Government is currently paying annual costs of [REDACTED] for OH, [REDACTED] for G&A, and [REDACTED] in profit, for a total of [REDACTED] per year.
- (d) Under the WICS contract, the Government is currently paying annual costs of [REDACTED] for OH, [REDACTED] for G&A, and [REDACTED] for profit, for a total of [REDACTED] per year.

Thus, for all four contracts, the Government is currently paying a total of [REDACTED] per year in quadruplicate OH and profit. All contractors' profit and indirect rates vary, but on average for all four current contracts, the Government is currently paying 8% in OH, 7% in G&A, and 8% in profit. The total value of the consolidated requirement, before OH and profit is applied, is expected to be around [REDACTED]; so if these averages hold, applying the build-up to the consolidated contract would equate to approximately [REDACTED]

in OH [REDACTED] in G&A [REDACTED] and [REDACTED] in profit [REDACTED] for a total of [REDACTED], or approximately [REDACTED] per year. Consolidating these requirements would therefore reduce the yearly cost from [REDACTED] to approximately [REDACTED], a savings of approximately [REDACTED] per year, as summarized in Table 3:

Table 3 – Overhead and Profit Savings

Overhead and Profit	Annual Savings	Total Savings*
Overhead	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
G&A	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
Profit	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
Total	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

- (2) **Contract Access Fee (CAF).** The Government is currently paying [REDACTED] per year in CAF to the U.S. General Services Administration (GSA). The CAF is a fee GSA charges users to utilize their GSA contracts. By consolidating these requirements and executing an in-house contract at SAIO, the Government will save a total of [REDACTED] over the life of the contract, or an annual average of [REDACTED].
- iii) **Administrative savings.** A single, consolidated contract will significantly reduce administrative costs by eliminating duplication of effort and resources required for multiple parallel acquisitions that are working towards the same common goal. Conducting separate acquisitions for each requirement will result in at least four (4) contracting activities conducting separate source selections whereas this contract vehicle will consolidate requirements and will significantly reduce overall acquisition processes and timelines across all mission partners. On average, the acquisition lead time for a standalone contract for these types of services at a median value of [REDACTED], takes approximately 18 months. Assuming 12 federal holidays per year, a full-time employee works [REDACTED] hours. It is reasonable to assume that acquisitions of this magnitude take up approximately 50% of their work time, or approximately [REDACTED] hours per year, or [REDACTED] hours for 18 months of work [REDACTED]. The Contracting Specialist, Contracting Officer, and 21 CS representatives all have an average hourly rate of [REDACTED] based on being a GS-12 Step 4 located in Colorado Springs. Each acquisition would require at least one Contract Specialist and Contracting Officer, or two full-time employees per acquisition. At [REDACTED] hours each, at a rate of [REDACTED], each acquisition would cost [REDACTED] for contracting personnel. All four acquisitions together would cost [REDACTED]. Five 21 CS personnel would be required to help write requirements, answer industry questions, plan the acquisition, evaluate proposals, etc. Since these personnel would be working on four requirements simultaneously, it is reasonable to assume it would take up virtually all their time, so for purposes of this calculation we'll assume 90%. Therefore, 90% of [REDACTED] hours is [REDACTED] per year, or [REDACTED] for 18 months. At a rate of [REDACTED] for five full-time employees working for 18 months, the total is [REDACTED]. Therefore, accomplishing four acquisitions at the same time, when adding together Contracting and 21 CS personnel, will

cost approximately [REDACTED] in administrative costs. Reducing the acquisitions from four to one will therefore save approximately [REDACTED]. Although these would not be recurring costs, for the sake of consistency, the savings equate to approximately [REDACTED] per year.

- iv) **Work Center Realignment.** Currently, there is no consistency between what the contractors do and what civilians do across the three locations or across contracts. At some locations, certain functions are accomplished by a contractor, and at other locations those same functions are accomplished by civilian personnel. This consolidation effort allows the overall requirements to be tackled from a strategic perspective, giving 21 CS the opportunity to realign certain work centers and have civilians perform “Tier 2” advanced network management across all three locations. Advanced network management, aka “Tier 2,” are highly skilled specialists with expertise in specific areas (e.g., servers, networking, databases, security, ISE and Solar Winds). Network management would include remote diagnostics and software upgrades, configuring network switches, network health monitoring, and designing, implementation and installation of projects. Consolidation would provide the opportunity for 21 CS to realign all Tier 2 positions to be performed by civilians. These civilian positions will become available through the efficiencies gained from reducing the number of CORs (see paragraph 6.b.i below) and adding to the contract non-Tier 2 work currently done by civilians (DRSN, Technical Control Facility (TCF) and cable maintenance).

There are currently [REDACTED] Tier 2 infrastructure contractors and [REDACTED] Tier 2 operation contractors for CMSFS and SSFS. The Tier 2 network contractor salaries greatly exceed that of the contractors needed to fulfill the three commodities being added (DRSN, TCF and cable maintenance). The average combined annual salary for the [REDACTED] Tier 2 contractors is [REDACTED]. After consolidation, civilians will take on the Tier 2 work, and the contractors will take over the work the civilians vacate, including [REDACTED] additional CST positions.

Thus, realigning work centers to optimize the civilian/contractor workforce mix will result in civilians taking over the Tier 2 work, saving [REDACTED] per year. However, contractors will take over for civilians in the areas of DRSN, TCF, and cable maintenance, which is expected to cost [REDACTED] per year. Adding the [REDACTED] additional CSTs that will also be handed off from civilians, will cost an additional [REDACTED] per year. Therefore, establishing consistency between civilian and contractor work across the three sites is expected to create net annual savings of approximately [REDACTED], as summarized in Table 4:

Table 4 – Work Center Realignment Savings

Workcenter Realignment	Annual Savings	Total Savings*
Tier 2 support (civilians)	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
DRSN, TCF, cable maint (ktr)	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
CST increase (ktr)	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
Total	\$ [REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
Total Consolidation Savings		[REDACTED]

- v) **Summary.** Consolidation is expected to result in total monetary savings of approximately [REDACTED] as summarized in Table 5:

Table 5 – Summary of Monetary Benefits of Consolidation

Savings Type	Annual Savings	Total Savings*
Direct Contract Costs		
Indirect Contract Costs		
Profit and OH		
Contract Access Fee		
Administrative Savings		
Work Center Realignment		
Tier 2 support (civilians)		
DSRN, TCF, cable maint (ktr)		
CST increase (ktr)		
Total		
Total Consolidation Savings		

* [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

- b) **Non-monetary benefits.** As discussed in paragraph 4, there are additional efficiencies to be gained through consolidation:
- i) **More efficient use of 21 CS personnel.** 21 CS utilizes 15 CORs to surveil these contracts. Instead of dedicating their time to their core job functions, these personnel spend approximately 16-24 hours each per week dedicated to contract surveillance and related paperwork. If these requirements were consolidated, the number of CORs could be reduced from 16 to 6. For example, 21 CS currently has five CORs at SSFB that surveil WICS, two CORs at SSFB surveilling PEDS, four CORs at CMSFS surveilling NISSC II, and four BOS-IT CORs between SSFB and PSFS. Each contract covers similar requirements across all three sites. Since the four contracts are managed by four different organizations, it means the CORs need to manage four separate nomination and designation processes, attend four contract-specific trainings given by four different COs, create four separate Surveillance and Performance Monitoring (SPM) accounts in the Procurement Integrated Enterprise Environment (PIEE), do four separate surveillances, write four separate surveillance reports each month, and submit four separate Contractor Performance and Assessment Reporting System (CPARS) entries. If these contracts were combined, a single 21 CS COR cell could accomplish all those actions once, instead of four times. This would allow 21 CS to utilize their personnel more efficiently in two ways. First, each COR would spend less time on surveillance and related paperwork, allowing them more time to accomplish their core duties. Second, it would reduce the number of CORs required, freeing up personnel to accomplish other core duties.
 - ii) **Simplification of other consolidation efforts.** There are two other DAF-wide and government-wide consolidation efforts of IT and communications requirements underway. The first is the Base Infrastructure Modernization (BIM) effort, under the existing DAF Enterprise IT as a Service (EITaaS) strategic initiative. BIM will modernize the Base Area Network (BAN) non-secure intranet protocol router (NIPR) and

secure intranet protocol router (SIPR) network infrastructure from the wall plate to the service delivery switch at each base boundary. BIM is being rolled out in “waves,” with USSF bases falling under Wave 3, scheduled for award in Q4 FY25, and performance scheduled to begin relatively soon thereafter. Therefore, those functions described above related to the Air Force Network (AFNET) will eventually be descope from the consolidated contract and added to the BIM effort. If these requirements are not consolidated, all four contracts would need to be modified and descope, resulting in additional administrative burden. The second consolidation effort is driven by Executive Order (EO) 14240, Eliminating Waste and Saving Taxpayer Dollars by Consolidating Procurement, issued 20 March 2025. This consolidation effort will include 10 government-wide categories of “common goods and services,” one of which is IT, which will include IT professional services, products, and capability as a service. As of the writing of this D&F, very little information has been released on the details, scope, or implementation of the EO. The information available on the GSA website says more information is pending Office of Management and Budget (OMB) implementation guidance. However, it is reasonable to assume that even if GSA can do portions of the consolidated CNECTS requirement, many aspects of it are military-unique, and thus not “common goods and services,” and thus not eligible for GSA. Therefore, only certain requirements are expected to be descope, which, like for BIM, will be much simpler when done under one contract instead of four.

DETERMINATION

_____ is the designated approval authority for this action. The determination above includes the acquisition strategy information required in FAR 7.107-2, including supporting documentation that consolidation does not have any negative impact on small business small business concerns will be included in the acquisition strategy, IAW FAR 7.102-2(a)(4) and (5). Specifically, this acquisition will be conducted as a 100% competitive (a) set-aside and will direct approval _____ in _____ This proposed strategy is conditioned on SBA’s release of existing 8(a) requirements and acceptance of the new contract into the 8(a) program IAW 13 CFR 124.504

The total cost to the Government of these four requirements is currently _____ per year. Through consolidation, the Government is expected to realize savings of approximately _____ per year, or approximately _____. Consolidation will therefore far exceed the minimum threshold of _____ and is expected to generate over _____ in savings over the life of the contract.

This determination has been made with full consideration of the requirements of FAR Part 19, Small Business Programs. While the consolidation may result in a reduction in the number of prime contract opportunities for small businesses, the agency has determined that the significant cost savings, enhanced mission effectiveness, and lack of reasonable alternatives justify this decision. Furthermore, the agency is committed to implementing mitigation measures to maximize opportunities for small business participation through subcontracting.

Therefore, based on the findings above, I hereby determine that consolidating these requirements is

SEMPER VENATOR

necessary and justified, as the benefits are measurably substantial and critical to mission success.

Attachments:

1. RFI #1 Combined Responses from Industry

COORDINATION:

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

9/30/25

DATE

[REDACTED]

9/30/25

DATE

[REDACTED]

9/23/25

DATE

[REDACTED]

9/30/25

DATE

[REDACTED]

9/30/25

DATE

[REDACTED]

9/30/25

DATE

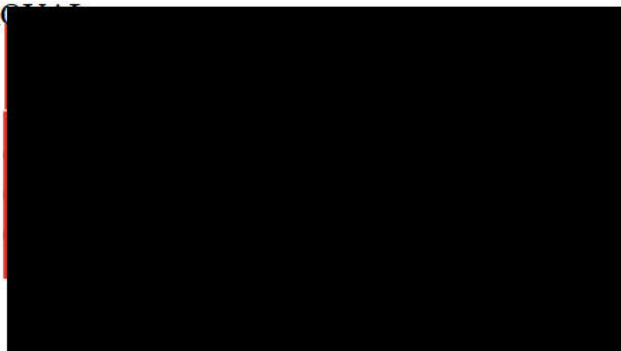
[REDACTED]

11/18/25

DATE

SEMPER VENATOR

APPROXIMATE



11/19/25

DATE

SEMPER VENATOR